traordinary objects that you store in your house are a rich oriental treasury in the heart of Florence. Can you tell us about the most meaningful relics that you brought from Morocco?

RI: Two big curtains. There are 22 doors embroidered on them, 11 on each. This gold circle-shaped ornament above represents the believer who is praying because if you watch attentively you may notice that these ornaments have silhouettes of arms. Nowadays the price of one curtain can reach 10.000 Eur, did you know? Because they are handcrafted, have more than 55 years and don't exist anymore.

AE: What is the difference in approach to dress of Moroccans in comparison with Europeans?

RI: Moroccans dress traditionally. Djellaba is a national long male costume. Meanwhile, the dress called Kaftan is the same thing but for women. You can find many stores on the streets of Marocco where they sell exclusively traditional dresses. Nevertheless, we are in 2024 people there still maintain the extremely high value of tradition and family. Meanwhile, Moroccan official costume, as I told you before, is a long dress with a hood and wide pants in addition to leather slippers with a sharp toes, the official costume everywhere in the rest of the world is a tie with a shirt, jacket and pants.

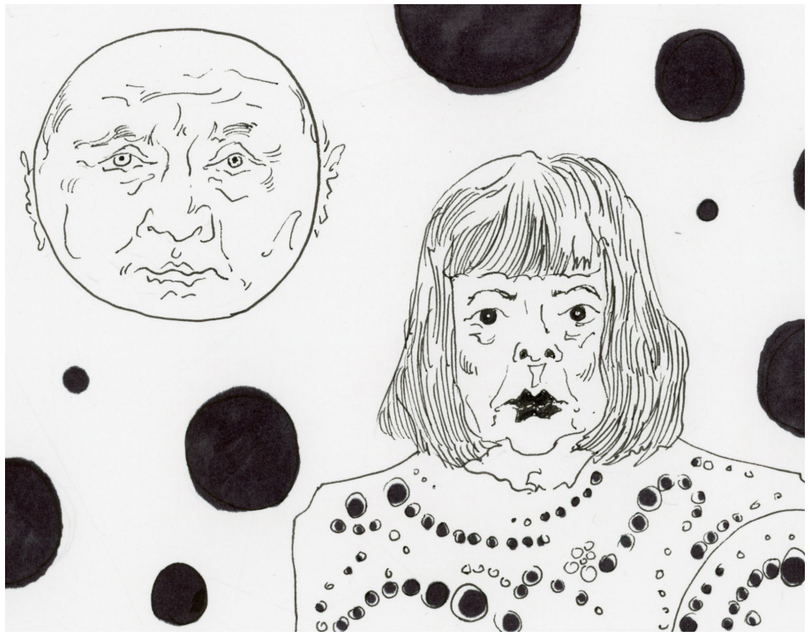
AE: You have been living in Florence since your twentieth, which means, for more or less 60 years already. From your point of view, how the attitude toward the fashion of Florentines has been changing throughout the years?

RI: What has been changing is how Florentines dress their bodies as well as how they dress their souls. Because we are strongly influenced by globalization. By cinema, music, social media, trends, etc. It has an impact on the subconscious of people and subsequently on the way how they express themselves.

IMPOSSIBLE RENDEZ - VOUS N O . 2

Yayoi Kusama & Vladimir Putin

In a whimsical alternate dimension where the boundaries of time and space were fluid, Yayoi Kusama and Vladimir Putin found themselves seated on opposite ends of a peculiar polka-dotted table in a room that seemed to stretch into infinity.



Drawing by Mobina Khalili

Yayoi Kusama: (wearing a vibrant polka-dotted dress and matching wig) Mr. Putin, do you not find the infinity of these dots enchanting? They are like the stars in the cosmos, don't you think?

Vladimir Putin: (looking around the room with a stoic expression) Ms. Kusama, I prefer to focus on the realities of geopolitics, not whimsical patterns.

Yayoi Kusama: (waves a polka-dotted hand) Oh, but imagine if the world were covered in dots! A global collaboration of infinite connections, much like my art.

Vladimir Putin: (raises an eyebrow) I prefer order and control over chaos. My Russia is not a canvas to be dotted.

Yayoi Kusama: (smiling) Mr. Putin, my dots represent the interconnectedness of all things. Perhaps your Russia could use a touch of whimsy.

Vladimir Putin: (leaning forward) I prefer strength and resilience. Not whimsy.

Yayoi Kusama: (grinning) But strength can be found in the most unexpected places, even in the tiniest dot. Have you ever considered the power of a single dot in a vast canvas?

Vladimir Putin: (crosses his arms) I deal with the canvas of politics, not art.

Yayoi Kusama: (suddenly produces a polka-dotted matryoshka doll) Ah, but politics and art can dance together! Look, a political statement in the form of dots.

Vladimir Putin: (examines the doll) Interesting. But my focus is on the strength and unity of my nation, not dolls.

Written by AI
Edited by Aleksandra Eremashvili

As the impossible conversation continued, the room seemed to swirl with dots of various sizes and colors, a surreal merging of Kusama's artistic vision and Putin's pragmatic world. In this whimsical encounter, the boundaries between the rigid and the abstract, the political and the artistic, blurred into a kaleidoscope of infinite possibilities that could only exist in the realm of the impossible.